



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Philip's Academy

School Website: <http://www.stphilipschurchsc.org/st-philips-academy>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

St. Philip's Academy (Charleston, SC, 29401), as reflected in the publicly accessible crawl content for the school's site, does not present itself as a classical school in the sense of the Six Essential Elements framework. The crawl content available for analysis appears to be a 404 page with minimal substantive text, offering no clear statements about religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose and goals aligned with virtue formation, a classical curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric or Great Books), traditional pedagogy (Socratic discourse, scholé, or memory work), faculty formation as a living curriculum, or explicit parent/community partnerships typical of classical schools. This lack of explicit classical signals places the school squarely in the Not Classical category across all six rubric categories based on the available materials. The primary public materials do not demonstrate a Great Books culture, liturgical integration, or the kinds of memory-based or Socratic pedagogies that define classical education per the Six Essential Elements.

To place this evaluation within the rubric, the Positive Keyword Indicators (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, Great Conversation, memory, etc.) and Negative Keyword Indicators (values-neutral language, workforce- or credential-focused framing, project-based-only approaches, etc.) from the Six Essential Elements framework were consulted to determine whether the school's public materials align with a classical orientation. The canonical keywords and signals of classical education are described in the knowledge-base documents (e.g., Six Essential Elements and the associated keyword lexicon). In this case, the available public crawl yields no substantive match to quintessential classical signals, so the overall assessment is Not Classical across all six categories. For transparency, the relevant keyword resources include the explicit lists of positive keywords (e.g., truth, virtue, beauty, theology, liturgy, wonder, Great Conversation, memory, etc.) and foundational categories described in the Six Essential Elements document and its accompanying lexicon.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot - The public crawl evidence for St. Philip's Academy (Charleston, SC, 29401) shows no explicit Classical signals in any of the six categories. The available material is a 404 page referencing a church site, with no meaningful articulation of a classical curriculum, pedagogy, or community formation. Therefore, all six categories are assessed as NOT CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The crawl content for the school shows a 404 page and a link back to a church site, with no explicit articulation of transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, liturgical practice, or communal sacred life within the school's curriculum. This provides no textual basis for the religious/metaphysical signals described in the classical rubric.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Public materials: 0 recognizable items from the Positive Keyword Indicators (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, Great Conversation) are evident in the accessible crawl text. The Negative Keyword Indicators also do not surface in the available content. - Classical keyword sources (for reference): Truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; worship; sacred music; wonder; Great Conversation; memory; and related transcendental terms appear in the Positive Keyword lists, but none are present in the public crawl text. See the Six Essential Elements keyword summaries for reference.

Why this rating - Without explicit references to transcendent moral realism, theological grounding, or liturgical/community practices within the school's public materials, the category fails to meet the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria. The absence of these signals in accessible content supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials do not articulate a classical telos (formation in virtue and wisdom) or the primacy of truth/goodness/beauty as real, knowable ends. The visible content is a 404 page with no stated purpose beyond a church/academy context, lacking articulation of formation over information, or the through-line of classical human excellence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords expected (e.g., formation, virtue, human flourishing, scholé, telos, true/good/beautiful) are not evidenced in the crawl text. Negative indicators (e.g., workforce-prep framing, job-readiness emphasis, utilitarianism) are likewise not detectable in the public crawl. Using the Six Essential Elements as a benchmark, there is no alignment signal in the accessible content.

Why this rating - Because the site content lacks explicit statements about formation in virtue/wisdom, the reality of pursuing truth/goodness/beauty, or a classical telos, the category is NOT CLASSICAL. The lack of textual signals prevents meeting the classical purposes and goals outlined in the rubric.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is no accessible content indicating a grammar/logic/rhetoric curriculum, no Great Books or history-integration language, no mention of the Great Conversation, and no explicit curricular structure described publicly. The visible crawl result is a 404 page with minimal text. Hence, there is no curricular signal for classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators such as grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history-as-civilizational study, and the cultivation of wonder are not present in the crawl text; negative indicators (e.g., project-based learning replacing core liberal arts) cannot be evaluated from the crawl text either. The governance of curriculum signals in the Six Elements document would require visible evidence; none is present here.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit curriculum signals (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, history-as-subject, and wonder) leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The crawl text contains no references to pedagogical practices such as contemplative scholé, memory/chanting for lower grades, Socratic seminars, or high-school rhetoric and public speaking. The 404 page provides no pedagogy details. Therefore, no classical pedagogy signals are evident.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive pedagogical signals (e.g., contemplative/restful learning, chant/memory, Socratic seminars, rhetorical training) are not visible in the crawl text. The keyword framework from the Six Elements yields these signals; they are not evidenced publicly for this school.

Why this rating - With no detectable classical pedagogy signals in the public crawling results, the category is NOT CLASSICAL. The absence of the learning rhythms described in the classical pedagogy lexicon (Scholé,

memory work, Socratic dialogue, rhetoric training) supports this rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The accessible crawl does not describe the faculty as living curriculum, mentors, or models of virtue, nor does it present a faculty portrait as the core of the school. The 404 text provides no data about faculty culture or professional formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive faculty signals (model teachers, living curriculum, collegiality, professional formation in classical pedagogy) are not evidenced in the crawl content. The keywords from the Six Elements lexicon would flag such signals if present; they are not detectable here.

Why this rating - Without public articulation of a classical faculty culture, the category fails to meet the criteria. The Not Classical designation follows from the lack of faculty signals in the accessible content.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The crawl text shows no mention of parent partnerships, co-teaching models, parent formation programs, or open-campus visitation policies. The 404 content provides no evidence of a parent/community framework typical of classical schools.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive parent/community keywords (partnership with parents as co-teachers, parent education programs, open visits) are not evidenced in the crawl content. The classical keyword framework would flag such signals if present; they are not detected here.

Why this rating - The absence of parent/community signals in publicly accessible content yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Parents & Community.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 2: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - If the school aimed to move toward a CLASSICAL orientation, the following needle-moving changes (grounded in the Six Essential Elements framework) would be needed: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Explicitly articulate transcendental moral realism, grounded theology, and liturgical/community practices in the school's public materials (truth/goodness/beauty as real, theology as governing disciplines, worship/music as integral to education). Implement a liturgical rhythm (morning prayers, songs, liturgical calendar) and reference sacred tradition in curriculum scope. This would create a textual basis for the religious foundations signals the rubric requires. - School Purpose and Goal: Define a clear telos anchored in formation—virtue, wisdom, and human excellence—rather than job market preparation. Emphasize scholé, contemplation, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as ends. Publicly present a mission statement that aligns with classical aims. - Curriculum: Adopt and publicly publish a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integrate Great Books and history as a through-line across disciplines, and implement a Great Conversation approach. Establish a curriculum map and reading lists aligned with the Great Books tradition, including exposure to primary sources and classics. - Pedagogy: Establish a dual rhythm of contemplative scholé and rigorous inquiry. In lower grades, incorporate memory work, chanting, and singing; in upper grades, implement Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. Demonstrate a pathway from K-8 with Socratic/academic discussion in higher grades. - Faculty: Build a living curriculum through mentor-teachers who model virtue and scholarship; cultivate collegial faculty culture; publish a teacher profile/portrait that reflects the classical ideal. - Parents & Community: Forge strong partnerships with parents as co-teachers, provide parent education (book studies, seminars), and invite parents to visit the school; implement a concerted outreach to build a classical community.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.